

Consubstantiation Affirm

doc-consubstantiation-affirm

Sacraments · Lord's Supper · doctrine · divided_lineages

DISPUTED

score 0.750
confidence low

Statement under examination

Christ is bodily present in, with, and under the bread and wine of the Lord's Supper without the elements being substantially changed.

In plain language

This proposition says Christ is bodily present in, with, and under the bread and wine while the bread and wine stay bread and wine. The lexical pivot is the little verb is in the words this is my body in 1 Corinthians 11:24. The Greek verb *estin*, which the lexicon describes as the verb to be with various uses, is used in the New Testament both for plain identity and for figurative predication, so the grammar by itself does not force a bodily presence in the element. The parallel cup saying shows this, because it says this cup is the new covenant in my blood, and the cup is plainly not the covenant in a flat literal sense, and the same copula carries figures in I am the vine, I am the door, I am the bread, the rock was Christ, and these are two covenants. There is real weight on the presence side. In 1 Corinthians 10:16 Paul calls the cup a sharing in the blood of Christ and the bread a sharing in the body of Christ, using the word *koinonia*, and in John 6 Jesus uses a strong word, *trogo*, that means to gnaw or chew, for eating his flesh. But *koinonia* means participation or fellowship, and it does not say whether that participation comes by a body located in or under the bread, by a change of substance, by a spiritual receiving, or by covenant union. The words leave the how unspecified. Other texts pull the other way. The phrase for my remembrance appears twice, and Paul says the church proclaims the Lord's death until he comes, which assumes the Lord is awaited and not yet bodily arrived. In Acts the same body is lifted up and taken into heaven and is said to return in the same way it left. In Luke the risen Jesus is handled and shows flesh and bones in one place. And in John the saying the flesh profits nothing and the words are spirit steers the eating toward a spiritual mode. The honest reading of the word data is that this is materially contested. The verb can bear a presence reading and *koinonia* and *trogo* give it real footing, but the in, with, and under specification is a metaphysical claim the vocabulary never makes, so the lexical evidence by itself neither affirms nor denies the formula.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0353	ἀναλαμβάνω	analambano	to take up	13
G0364	ἀνάμνησις	anamnesis	remembrance	4
G0740	ἄρτος	artos	bread	99
G0846	αὐτός	autos	it/s/he	
G0891	ἄχρι	achri	until	50
G1242	διαθήκη	diatheke	covenant	33
G1510	εἰμί	eimi	to be	2,407
G2064	ἐρχομαι	erchomai	to come/go	640

G2806	κλάω	klao	to break	15
G2842	κοινωνία	koinonia	participation	18
G3772	οὐρανός	ouranos	heaven	280
G3778	οὗτος	houtos	this/he/she/it	1,419
G4221	ποτήριον	poterion	cup	33
G4561	σάρξ	sarx	flesh	151
G4983	σῶμα	soma	body	144
G5176	τρώγω	trogo	to eat	6

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: False

The proposition hangs on the institution copula ἐστίν in Τοῦτό ἐστιν τὸ σῶμά μου (1 Cor 11:24), and the lexicon itself glosses εἰμί as the verb to be with various uses and significations, so the bare grammar carries both literal identity and figurative predication and cannot by itself fix a local bodily presence in, with, and under the elements. The same copula links subject to predicate in I am the vine (John 15:1), I am the door (John 10:9), I am the bread (John 6:35), the rock was Christ (1 Cor 10:4), and these are two covenants (Gal 4:24), where no substantial co-location is meant. The real-presence-flavored anchors are genuine: κοινωνία in 1 Cor 10:16 makes the cup and bread a sharing in the blood and body of Christ, and τρώγω in John 6:54-58 is a visceral gnaw or chew verb. But κοινωνία means participation and fellowship, which the words do not narrow to bodily co-presence rather than spiritual or covenantal union, and John 6:63 says the flesh profits nothing and the words are spirit. The phrase in, with, and under is a metaphysical specification the vocabulary never supplies, so the lexical pattern is materially contested.

Scripture

1Cor.11.24 · neutral · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G3778 οὗτος, G1510 εἰμί, G0364 ἀνάμνησις

Force. Τοῦτό ἐστιν τὸ σῶμά μου, this is my body, sets the copula ἐστίν between the demonstrative pointing at the broken bread and the predicate σῶμα. The brief lexicon glosses εἰμί as the verb to be with various uses and significations, so the present indicative here is the same form used both for literal identity and for figurative predication across the canon, and on its own it neither requires nor excludes a bodily presence in or under the element. The clause closes with εἰς τὴν ἐμὴν ἀνάμνησιν, for my remembrance, where ἀνάμνησις means recollection, orienting the act toward calling to mind an absent referent rather than toward a metaphysical change or a co-location of body with bread.

1Cor.11.25 · complicates · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G4221 ποτήριον, G1242 διαθήκη, G0364 ἀνάμνησις

Force. The cup word, τοῦτο τὸ ποτήριον ἡ καινὴ διαθήκη ἐστίν ἐν τῷ ἐμῷ αἵματι, this cup is the new covenant in my blood, predicates the cup as the covenant, not as blood located in or under the liquid. Reading ἐστίν here as strict local identity would make the cup itself the covenant, which the predicate forbids, so the same copula in the parallel bread word likewise resists a flat localized-presence construal. The repeated τοῦτο ποιεῖτε εἰς τὴν ἐμὴν ἀνάμνησιν reinforces a remembrance frame. The phrase ἐν τῷ ἐμῷ αἵματι uses the preposition ἐν, but ἐν here marks the sphere of the covenant in the blood, not a metaphysical in, with, and under that the wording would have to spell out.

1Cor.11.26 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0740 ἄρτος, G0891 ἄχρι, G2064 ἔρχομαι

Force. τὸν θάνατον τοῦ κυρίου καταγγέλλετε ἄχρι οὗ ἔλθῃ, you proclaim the Lord's death until he comes, sets the rite within an interval bounded by ἄχρι, until, with the aorist subjunctive ἔλθῃ of a future coming. The grammar presupposes that the Lord is awaited and not yet arrived bodily, which fits a present bodily absence rather than a continuous bodily presence localized with each loaf and cup.

1Cor.10.16 · neutral · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2842 κοινωνία, G4983 σῶμα, G4221 ποτήριον

Force. τὸ ποτήριον ... οὐχὶ κοινωνία ἐστὶν τοῦ αἵματος τοῦ Χριστοῦ; τὸν ἄρτον ... οὐχὶ κοινωνία τοῦ σώματος τοῦ Χριστοῦ ἐστίν; the cup is a κοινωνία of the blood of Christ and the bread a κοινωνία of the body of Christ. This is the strongest real-presence-flavored anchor, and the verse really does join the elements to the body and blood. But the brief lexicon glosses κοινωνία as participation, and across its eighteen occurrences the word denotes fellowship, sharing, and participation, never substantial co-location. The text affirms a real participation in Christ through the elements, yet the vocabulary does not specify whether that participation is by bodily presence in or under the bread, by a substantial change, by a spiritual reception, or by covenantal union, so it underdetermines the in, with, and under formula.

John.6.56 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G5176 τρώγω, G4561 σὰρξ

Force. ὁ τρώγων μου τὴν σάρκα καὶ πίνων μου τὸ αἶμα, the one who eats my flesh and drinks my blood. The verb τρώγω is glossed as to gnaw, munch, crunch of animals and to eat of men, a more visceral word than the ordinary ἐσθίω, and it recurs in John 6:54, 56, 57, 58, intensifying the eating language that a bodily-presence reading invokes. This is genuine lexical weight on the realism side. The realism it forces is the realism of true participation in Christ, but the discourse does not itself supply the metaphysics of how the flesh is present, so it does not by itself establish a presence in or under bread.

John.6.63 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key terms. G4561 σὰρξ, G1510 εἰμί

Force. τὸ πνεῦμά ἐστιν τὸ ζωοποιοῦν, ἡ σὰρξ οὐκ ὠφελεῖ οὐδέν, the Spirit is what gives life, the flesh profits nothing, with τὰ ῥήματα ἃ ἐγὼ λελάληκα ὑμῖν πνεῦμά ἐστιν καὶ ζωὴ ἐστίν, the words I have spoken are spirit and life. Coming at the close of the same bread discourse that used τρώγω, this dominical comment relativizes a crassly fleshly eating and steers reception toward a spiritual mode. The referent of σὰρξ in this verse is itself contested, whether it denies a fleshly eating of the bread or names a broader carnal mode of understanding, so the verse counterweights the visceral τρώγω without settling the mode.

Luke.24.39 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key terms. G4561 σὰρξ, G1510 εἰμί

Force. ἴδετε τὰς χεῖράς μου καὶ τοὺς πόδας μου ὅτι ἐγὼ εἰμι αὐτός, ψηλαφήσατέ με καὶ ἴδετε, see my hands and feet that it is I myself, handle me and see, with πνεῦμα σάρκα καὶ ὀστέα οὐκ ἔχει, a spirit does not have flesh and bones. The verb ψηλαφάω is to touch or handle, and σὰρξ with ὀστέον presents the risen body as touchable and locally bounded, seen and handled in one place. A single body so described is in tension with the same body being bodily present with bread in many places at once.

Acts.1.9 · complicates · genre: narrative

Key terms. G3772 οὐρανός, G0846 αὐτός

Force. ἐπύρθη καὶ νεφέλη ὑπέλαβεν αὐτὸν ἀπὸ τῶν ὀφθαλμῶν αὐτῶν, he was lifted up and a cloud took him from their eyes. The verb ἐπείρω is to lift up and the prepositional phrase ἀπὸ τῶν ὀφθαλμῶν marks spatial removal, so the same body just seen is narrated as departing upward and away, framing his post-ascension presence as bodily located in heaven rather than diffused under earthly elements.

Acts.1.11 · complicates · genre: narrative

Key terms. G3778 οὕτως, G2064 ἔρχομαι, G0353 ἀναλαμβάνω

Force. οὗτος ὁ Ἰησοῦς ὁ ἀναλημφθεὶς ἀφ' ὑμῶν εἰς τὸν οὐρανὸν οὕτως ἐλεύσεται ὃν τρόπον ἐθεάσασθε αὐτὸν πορευόμενον εἰς τὸν οὐρανόν, this same Jesus who was taken up from you into heaven will come in the same manner. The demonstrative οὗτος ties the future bodily return to the very body taken up by ἀναλαμβάνω, and the future ἐλεύσεται with ὃν τρόπον, in the same manner, marks the body as in heaven and yet to return, which is hard to reconcile with a continuous bodily presence in the elements now.

John.15.1 · complicates · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G1510 εἰμί

Force. ἐγώ εἰμι ἡ ἀμπελος ἡ ἀληθινή, I am the true vine, places the same copula εἰμί between the speaker and a predicate that is plainly not a substantial identity. Alongside ἐγώ εἰμι ἡ θύρα, I am the door (John 10:9), ἐγώ εἰμι ὁ ἄρτος, I am the bread (John 6:35), ἡ πέτρα δὲ ἦν ὁ Χριστός, the rock was Christ (1 Cor 10:4), and αὗται γάρ εἰσιν δύο διαθήκαι, these are two covenants (Gal 4:24), this shows the copula carrying figurative predication where no local presence is meant, which is why the bare ἐστίν in the bread word cannot decide the question.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
1Cor.11.23	1Cor.15.3	tsk	1
1Cor.11.24	1Cor.5.7	tsk	1
1Cor.11.24	Exod.12.14	tsk	1
Acts.1.11	Dan.7.13	tsk	1
John.6.63	Gen.2.7	tsk	1
John.6.63	John.6.68	tsk	1
Acts.1.10	2Kgs.2.11	tsk	1
Luke.24.39	Luke.23.46	tsk	1

Complicating texts

1Cor.11.24 · addressed

The copula ἐστίν in τοῦτό ἐστιν τὸ σῶμά μου is the chief lexical support a presence reading invokes. It is addressed by the lexicon gloss of εἰμί as the verb to be with various uses, by the parallel cup word predicating the cup as the covenant which cannot be flat identity, and by the figurative copula in I am the vine, the door, the bread, the rock was Christ, and these are two covenants. The verb is therefore neutral on bodily presence and the verdict is left disputed rather than affirmed on its strength.

1Cor.10.16 · addressed

κοινωνία of the body and blood is the genuine real-presence-flavored anchor that consubstantiation shares with the substantial-change and spiritual-presence readings. It is addressed by noting that κοινωνία is glossed participation and across its occurrences means fellowship and sharing, so it affirms a real participation in Christ without specifying that the participation is by a bodily presence in or under the bread as opposed to a spiritual or covenantal union. It underdetermines the proposition.

John.6.56 · addressed

τρῶγω, to gnaw or chew, is the strongest single word on the realism side and is weighed honestly as such. It is addressed by observing that the visceral verb forces the realism of true participation in Christ but does not itself supply the metaphysics of how the flesh is present, and by John 6:63 in the same discourse saying the flesh profits nothing and the words are spirit, so it does not establish a bodily presence in or under bread.

1Cor.11.26 · addressed

ἄχρι οὗ ἔλθῃ, until he comes, frames the rite as a proclamation during the Lord's awaited absence. This complicates the affirmation by presupposing he is not yet bodily come, and it is weighed as evidence against a continuous bodily presence in the element, contributing to the disputed verdict.

Luke.24.39 · addressed

σὰρξ καὶ ὅστέα with ψηλαφάω describes a locally bounded, touchable risen body. This complicates a body that would be bodily present with bread in many places simultaneously. It is addressed by treating the localized character of the risen body as a genuine tension that keeps the verdict disputed rather than affirmed, while not by itself foreclosing accounts that allow a multiplied or spiritual mode of presence.

John.6.63 · unaddressed

ἡ σὰρξ οὐκ ὠφελεῖ οὐδέν is not fully resolvable on lexical grounds alone, because whether σὰρξ here denies a fleshly eating of the bread or names a broader carnal mode of understanding is itself contested. The referent of σὰρξ in this one verse cannot be settled from morphology and concordance data in the bundle, so it is left open and flagged.

Concordance traversed

G1510, G3778, G4983, G2842, G5176, G0740, G4561, G0364, G0891, G2064, G3772, G0353, G4221, G1242, G2806

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

The bundle reports no variant units for the cited verses and marks the passages outside current ECM scope, so the CBGM apparatus was treated as shadow. The minor textual marks at 1 Cor 11:24 and 11:25, such as the optional clause about the body given for you, do not alter the copula, the κοινωνία wording in 1 Cor 10:16, or the remembrance frame on which the verdict turns.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, sacramental_realism, memorialism

analogia scripturae invoked

consubstantiation_local_presence_reading: disputed · Takes ἐστὶν as a real predication so that the body and blood are present in, with, and under the bread and wine while the elements remain bread and wine. Its strongest lexical support is κοινωνία in 1 Cor 10:16, a real participation in the body and blood, and τρώγω in John 6, a visceral eating, together with the unqualified copula. The reading is genuinely available, but the in, with, and under specification is not in the vocabulary, and κοινωνία means participation without naming a bodily mode, so the support is real yet not decisive.

transubstantiation_substantial_change_reading: disputed · Takes ἐστὶν as a strict identity in which the bread becomes the body so that what remains is the body under the appearance of bread. It shares the κοινωνία and τρώγω anchors with the consubstantiation reading and presses the copula toward identity. The vocabulary does not distinguish a change of substance from a presence alongside the substance, so the words cannot adjudicate between this reading and consubstantiation, and both face the figurative-copula counterweight.

spiritual_presence_reading: disputed · Reads κοινωνία as a true spiritual participation in Christ received by faith, and John 6:63, the Spirit gives life, the flesh profits nothing, as steering reception toward a spiritual mode rather than a local bodily one. This is well supported by the participation vocabulary and by the John 6 discourse, but the contested referent of σάρξ in John 6:63 keeps it from being confirmed on lexical data alone.

memorial_reading: disputed · Leans on εἰς τὴν ἐμὴν ἀνάμνησιν, for my remembrance, repeated twice, on the figurative copula in I am the vine and the door, and on ἄχρι οὗ ἔλθῃ, until he comes, to read the rite as remembrance and proclamation during bodily absence. This is strongly supported by the surrounding lexis, but it does not erase the literal availability of ἐστίν or the force of κοινωνία and τρώγω, so it too falls short of closing the question lexically.

By analogy of Scripture the cup word, the κοινωνία of 1 Cor 10:16, the τρώγω discourse and its John 6:63 qualifier, and the ascension and resurrection narratives are read alongside the bread word. The copula remains the pivot, and because εἰμί is two-valued in usage and κοινωνία names participation without specifying a bodily mode, no single lens resolves the proposition on lexis and morphology alone.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. How should the words this is my body and this cup is the new covenant in my blood be understood in relation to the bread and wine of the Lord's Supper, and what does the canon indicate about the mode and the location of Christ's body in that rite?

The original stem encodes a specific metaphysical formula, bodily present in, with, and under the elements without the elements being substantially changed, which presupposes a particular construal of ἐστίν, of κοινωνία, and a particular christological account of the body. The verdict is derived on the original stem from lexical evidence regardless of which tradition the formula favors. The neutralized form removes the preloaded metaphysical claim and asks the open lexical question about mode and location.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Cor.11.24
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Cor.10.16
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	John.6.56
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1510
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2842
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G5176
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0364
interlinear	SBLGNT-text	SBLGNT-EULA	no	Luke.24.39
interlinear	SBLGNT-text	SBLGNT-EULA	no	John.6.63
interlinear	SBLGNT-text	SBLGNT-EULA	no	Acts.1.11
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	John.6.63

License audit

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Flags

lexically-disputed · ecm-shadow · complicating-unresolved